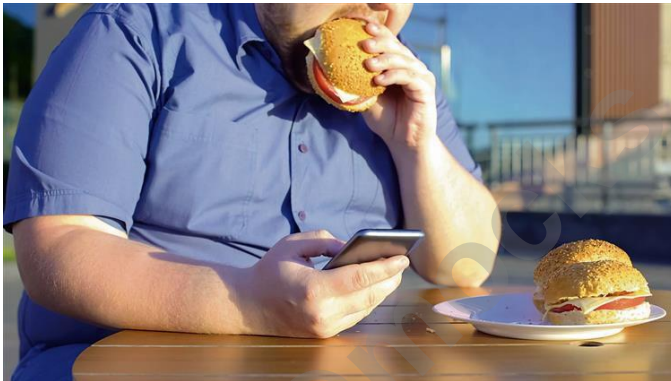


India's dietary crisis

INDIA is facing a health crisis, with 56.4 per cent of the total disease burden **attributed to** unhealthy dietary practices, according to the latest report of the Indian Council of Medical Research-National Institute of Nutrition (ICMR-NIN). Unhealthy eating **habits**, including the consumption of processed foods high in salt, sugar and fats, **have** become **alarmingly prevalent**, with the **proliferation** of fast food chains and the easy availability of packaged snacks enabling a culture of convenience **at the expense of** health. A **sedentary lifestyle**, along with excessive mobile phone use, **has exacerbated** the problem, **leading to** a rise in **obesity**, diabetes and other **non-communicable diseases** (NCDs).

The **consequences** of these dietary trends **are staggering**. Obesity rates are **soaring**, with about 25 per cent of the Indians now classified as overweight or **obese**; children and **adolescents** are also increasingly **falling victim to** unhealthy eating habits. The ICMR-NIN guidelines **call for** a return to traditional, nutrient-rich foods and **emphasise** the importance of regular physical activity. Consuming fruits, vegetables, **legumes** and whole grains while **shunning** the **intake** of processed foods **is essential** to reshaping dietary behaviour.



However, **concerted** efforts are a **must** to **facilitate** access to nutritious foods. **Policies** that promote food security, regulate food advertising and **incentivise** the production and consumption of healthy foods **are** needed. Nutrition literacy programmes should be integrated into school **curricula** so that children focus on their health from an early age. A collective **effort** from **policymakers**, healthcare professionals, educators and communities **can** help **combat** the problem. By prioritising the promotion of healthy eating habits and **addressing** the **socioeconomic** factors **driving** poor dietary choices, we can **stem** the **tide** of NCDs and build a healthier future for all Indians. The time to act is now.

- Red/blue coloring of words in the sentence indicates subject verb relationship; where 'red' denotes 'subject' and 'blue' denotes 'verb'

Vocabulary

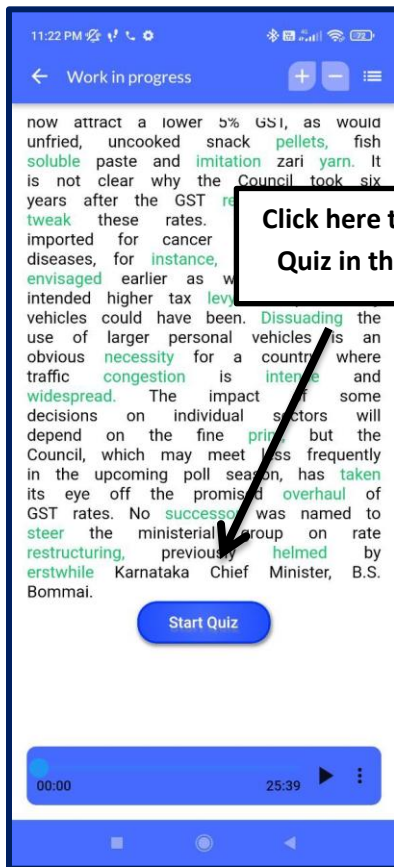
1. **Dietary** (adjective) – Nutritional, alimentary, nutritive, dietetic, food-related
खाद्य संबंधी
2. (be) **attributed** (to) (adjective) – Ascribed, credited, assigned, imputed, referred के लिए जिम्मेदार ठहराना
3. **Alarming** (adverb) – Disturbingly, shockingly, worryingly, frighteningly, unsettlingly चिंताजनक ढंग से
4. **Prevalent** (adjective) – Widespread, common, pervasive, ubiquitous, rife प्रचलित
5. **Proliferation** (noun) – Growth, multiplication, increase, expansion, spread प्रसार
6. **At the expense of** (phrase) – To the detriment of, sacrificing, at the cost of, by compromising की कीमत पर
7. **Sedentary** (adjective) – Inactive, stationary, non-active, seated, desk-bound निष्क्रिय
8. **Exacerbate** (verb) – Worsen, aggravate, intensify, heighten, amplify बिगाड़ देना
9. **Lead** (to) (verb) – Result in, cause, bring about, precipitate, give rise to कारण बनना
10. **Obesity** (noun) – Overweight, corpulence, fatness, heaviness, plumpness मोटापा
11. **Non-communicable disease** (NCD) (noun) – diseases that are not spread through infection or through other people, but are typically caused by unhealthy behaviours.
12. **Staggering** (adjective) – Astonishing, overwhelming, shocking, amazing, stunning चौंका देने वाला
13. **Soaring** (adjective) – Skyrocketing, escalating, climbing, mounting, rising तेजी से बढ़ता हुआ
14. **Obese** (adjective) – Overweight, corpulent, fat, plump, heavy मोटा
15. **Adolescent** (noun) – Teenager, youth, juvenile, minor, young person किशोर
16. **Fall victim to** (phrase) – Succumb to, be affected by, be susceptible to, suffer from का शिकार होना
17. **Call for** (phrasal verb) – Demand, require, necessitate, entail, need मांगना
18. **Emphasise** (verb) – Highlight, stress, underline, accentuate, underscore जोर देना
19. **Legume** (noun) – Pulse, bean, pea, lentil, pod दाल
20. **Shun** (verb) – Avoid, eschew, evade, steer clear of, abstain from बचना
21. **Intake** (noun) – Consumption, ingestion, uptake, input, absorption सेवन

22. **Essential** (adjective) – Crucial, necessary, indispensable, vital, fundamental आवश्यक
23. **Concerted** (adjective) – Coordinated, joint, collective, unified, combined संयुक्त
24. **Must** (noun) – Necessity, requirement, obligation, need, essential आवश्यकता
25. **Facilitate** (verb) – Enable, ease, assist, aid, simplify सुगम बनाना
26. **Incentivise** (verb) – Motivate, encourage, stimulate, spur, promote प्रोत्साहित करना
27. **Curricula** (noun) – Courses, educational programs, syllabi, academic plans, study programs पाठ्यक्रम
28. **Policymaker** (noun) – Legislator, official, decision-maker, regulator, authority नीति निर्माता
29. **Combat** (verb) – Fight, battle, contend, resist, oppose सामना करना
30. **Address** (verb) – Tackle, deal with, manage, handle, confront सुलझाना, निपटाना
31. **Socioeconomic** (adjective) – Social and economic, relating to society and economy, demographic and financial सामाजिक और आर्थिक
32. **Drive** (verb) – Propel, push, spur, motivate, influence प्रेरित करना
33. **Stem** (verb) – Stop, halt, arrest, check, curb रोकना
34. **Tide** (noun) – Wave, current, flow, stream, surge लहर

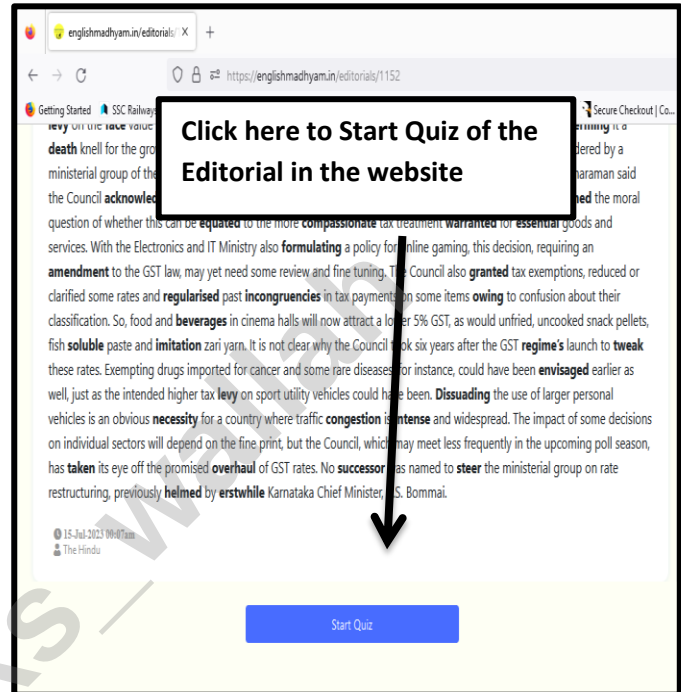
Summary of the Editorial

1. **Health Crisis:** India is experiencing a health crisis, with 56.4% of its disease burden due to unhealthy dietary practices.
2. **Dietary Habits:** Consumption of processed foods high in salt, sugar, and fats is widespread, driven by the proliferation of fast food chains and packaged snacks.
3. **Lifestyle Factors:** Sedentary lifestyles and excessive mobile phone usage exacerbate health issues, contributing to obesity, diabetes, and other non-communicable diseases (NCDs).
4. **Obesity Rates:** Approximately 25% of Indians are now overweight or obese, with children and adolescents particularly affected.
5. **ICMR-NIN Guidelines:** Recommendations include a return to traditional, nutrient-rich foods and regular physical activity.
6. **Dietary Recommendations:** Emphasis on consuming fruits, vegetables, legumes, and whole grains, and avoiding processed foods.
7. **Policy Needs:** Implementation of policies to promote food security and regulate food advertising is crucial.
8. **Healthy Food Incentives:** Policies should also incentivize the production and consumption of nutritious foods.
9. **Nutrition Education:** Nutrition literacy programs need integration into school curricula to encourage early health focus among children.
10. **Community Effort:** A collective effort from policymakers, healthcare professionals, educators, and communities is essential.
11. **Promotion of Healthy Eating:** Prioritizing the promotion of healthy eating habits is vital to address the issue effectively.
12. **Addressing Socioeconomic Factors:** Tackling socioeconomic factors that lead to poor dietary choices is necessary.
13. **Urgency of Action:** Immediate action is required to mitigate the crisis.
14. **Goal:** The aim is to stem the tide of NCDs and secure a healthier future for all Indians.
15. **Overall Strategy:** The strategy involves a multi-faceted approach focusing on dietary changes, education, policy implementation, and community engagement.

Practice Exercise: SSC Pattern Based



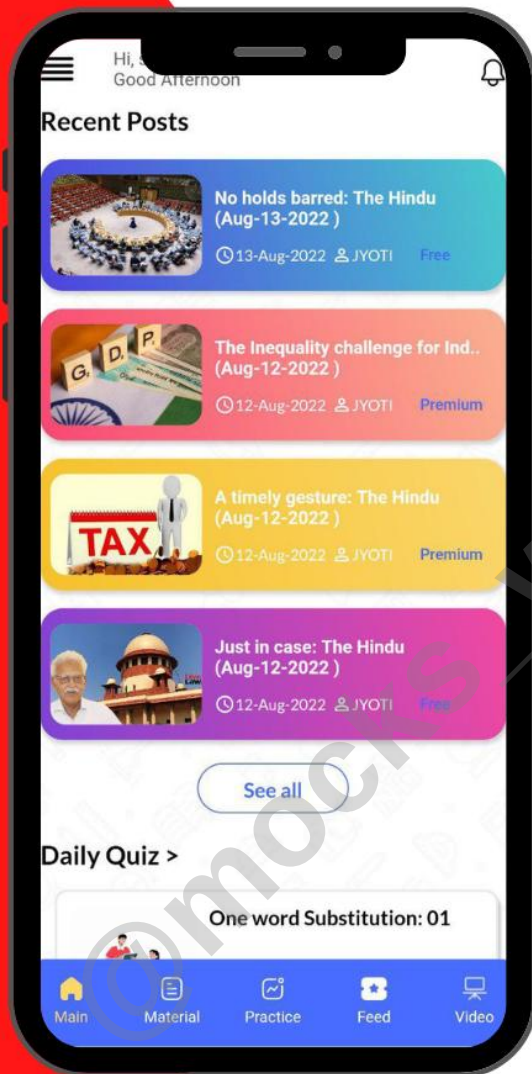
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